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OWNER'S GUIDE

You own SoloOS. Here's how to run it.

Put it live in about ten minutes, make it yours, and improve it whenever you want — no developer, no support desk, no waiting on anyone.

SoloOS · one-time purchase, yours to keep, rebrand, and run forever. This guide ships with your code.

FIRST THINGS FIRST

What you have

You've got the complete SoloOS codebase — one folder, a handful of files. It runs on **free hosting** (Netlify), and its AI runs on **your own key** from Anthropic (usually a few dollars a month). Nothing to subscribe to, nothing phoning home. Three things happen below: you put it online, you make it yours, and — the important part — you learn to change anything in it yourself.

STEP BY STEP

Put it live (about 10 minutes)

1 Make a free Netlify account

Go to netlify.com and sign up. The free tier is far more than a solo business needs.

2 Deploy your code

In Netlify, choose **Add new site** → **Deploy manually**, then drag your SoloOS folder onto the page. You'll get a live URL like `your-site.netlify.app`.

3 Turn on the AI

Create a key at console.anthropic.com → **API keys** → **Create key** (it starts with `sk-ant-` and shows once, so copy it). In Netlify, open **Site configuration** → **Environment variables**, add one named exactly `ANTHROPIC_API_KEY` with your key as the value, then **redeploy** (Deploys → Trigger deploy).

4 Open your site and set it up

Visit your URL. A short wizard asks for your business name, colors, logo, and a first user with a password. Fill it in — you're running.

THE ONE COST TO KNOW ABOUT

Netlify hosting is free at your scale. The AI is billed to your own Anthropic account as you use it — for one person, typically a few dollars a month. No middle-man markup, ever.

MAKE IT YOURS

Brand it, fill it, name it

Your brand

The wizard already set your name, colors, and logo; change any of it anytime in **Settings**. This is genuinely your software now — many owners run it as their own branded workspace, and nothing on screen says otherwise.

Bring in your data — the fast way

Already have contacts, a pipeline, or projects somewhere else? Don't retype them. In **Settings** → **Import your data**, upload a CSV (a CRM or spreadsheet export) or paste rows — and SoloOS reads the columns and files each one into the right place: people into Contacts, deals into your Pipeline, client work into Projects. You'll see a preview of exactly what it found, and nothing is added until you click **Add these to my workspace**. Got a lot? Import in a few smaller batches. You're moved in within minutes.

Your data & your address

Start adding real leads, projects, and goals (everything saves automatically). If you'd like it at `app.yourbusiness.com` instead of a Netlify address, add a custom domain in Netlify's **Domain settings** — optional, and it can wait.

KEEP A COPY OF YOUR CODE

Before you start changing things, stash the original zip somewhere safe. It's your clean starting point and your safety net.

Improve it yourself — with Claude

You don't have a support desk, and here's the secret: you don't need one. You have **Claude**, and because you **own the code**, you can change anything in it. Found a bug? Want a new button, a different layout, a whole new feature? Describe it in plain English and Claude does the work. Here's the loop.

1 Open your workshop

Go to **claude.ai** and start a new chat. Give it a name you'll come back to — like **"SoloOS — Developer"** (or "SoloOS — Feature Requests," or "SoloOS — Product Support"). One dedicated, named chat means Claude keeps the context of your app as you make changes over time.

2 Hand Claude the code

Upload your SoloOS zip into that chat — the same one you deployed. Now Claude can read every file in your app.

3 Ask in plain English

Describe what you want like you'd tell a teammate. You do **not** need to know how to code:

- "There's a bug: when I do X, Y happens. Please fix it."
- "Add a button on the pipeline that does Z."
- "Change the dashboard so the revenue card shows the quarter, not the year."

4 Get your updated code

Claude makes the change and gives you back the updated file — or a fresh zip. Download it.

5 Redeploy

Drag the new build onto your Netlify site, exactly like the first deploy. A minute later your change is live. That's the whole loop — repeat it whenever you want. No version to wait for, no one to ask.

GET GREAT RESULTS

A few habits that make this easy

ONE PROJECT, ONE CHAT

Keep using the same named chat so Claude remembers your app and your past changes. If it ever gets very long or slow, start a fresh chat and re-upload your latest zip for a clean, current copy.

ALWAYS KEEP YOUR LAST WORKING ZIP

Before deploying a new build, hold on to the one that works now. If a change misbehaves, roll back instantly by re-deploying the old zip. That's your undo button — it means you can experiment freely.

BE SPECIFIC

"It's broken" is hard to act on. "When I click Save on a lead, nothing happens and the screen flickers" is easy. Tell Claude what you did, what you expected, and what actually happened.

TRY BEFORE YOU TRUST, AND GO IN STEPS

Open your live site and test a change before relying on it. For bigger features, ask Claude to build them in stages and explain each one — cleaner results, and you learn your own app along the way.

The fine print, in plain English

It's yours to run

Rebrand it, change anything, and run it for your own business — it's yours outright. The one rule: SoloOS is licensed to you for your own use, so please don't resell it or share the code with others.

No support desk — by design

That's not a gap; it's the deal. Instead of waiting on a vendor, you have Claude as your developer and support line, any time. It's why SoloOS is a one-time purchase instead of a monthly bill.

IF SOMETHING'S OFF

Quick fixes

THE AI ISN'T RESPONDING

Check that `ANTHROPIC_API_KEY` is set in Netlify (Site configuration → Environment variables) and that you **redeployed** after adding it. Confirm your Anthropic account has billing set up.

MY CHANGES AREN'T SHOWING UP

Make sure you deployed the new build (not the old folder), then refresh. If it still looks old, do a hard refresh in your browser.

SOMETHING BROKE AFTER A CHANGE

Re-deploy your last working zip to roll back instantly, then take the issue back to your SoloOS chat with Claude and describe exactly what went wrong.

THAT'S IT

You own a complete business OS, it runs for pennies, and you can shape it into exactly what your practice needs. Go make it yours.